

There were many firsts for US military women. In 1967, Marine Corps Master Sergeant Barbara Dulinsky was the first woman Marine to serve in a combat theater. Major Norma A. Archer was the first Air Force woman to give daily briefings of key air strikes to the Seventh Air Force Headquarters staff in 1968. A year later, Lieutenant Commander Barbara Bole was the first Navy woman to get the Bronze Star with Combat “V” (for combat heroism), and in 1970, Army Colonel Clotilde Dent Bowen, MD, arrived in Vietnam to be chief psychiatrist—the only Black American physician in the Army. That same year, Air Force Major Barbara Thompson became the first female engineer to be assigned to the Rapid Engineer Deployable, Heavy Operations Repair Squadron. The service of these women paved the way for US military women thereafter.



Pallas Athene

This Vietnam-era guidon was lost for years before it was returned, no questions asked, to the US Army Women's Museum. It bears the WAC insignia: the head of a goddess of battle, who led through victory to peace and prosperity.

“Kids teased, ‘**Your momma** wears combat boots.’ **I did!**”

CLERK-TYPIST CAROL A. WILLIAMS, IN *WOMEN VIETNAM VETERANS: OUR UNTOLD STORIES*, 2015